

FREE GUIDE · 2026

# The Small Business Website Checklist

27 things every small-business website needs to look professional, get found on Google, and turn visitors into paying customers — the exact checklist we use when we build.

✓ 27-point checklist · print & tick as you go

## PART 1 · FOUNDATIONS

# Look professional & load fast

First impressions happen in under a second. These are the non-negotiables that make visitors trust you before they read a word.

- 01 ☐ **Your own domain name**  
yourbusiness.com — not a free .wordpress or .wixsite address. It's cheap and it signals you're a real business.

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- 02 ☐ **A secure padlock (HTTPS/SSL)**  
Browsers flag sites without it as "Not secure". Non-negotiable for trust and for Google ranking.

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- 03 ☐ **Loads in under 3 seconds**  
Every extra second loses visitors. Compress images and avoid bloated page builders.

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- 04 ☐ **Looks perfect on mobile**  
Over half your visitors are on a phone. Text readable, buttons tappable, nothing cut off.

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- 05 ☐ **A clear, consistent logo & colours**  
The same look across every page so you feel like one polished brand, not a patchwork.

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- 06 ☐ **Real photos, not just stock**  
A few genuine photos of you, your team or your work build more trust than any stock image.

## PART 2 · GET FOUND ON GOOGLE

# Show up when they search

A beautiful site nobody finds earns nothing. These get you visible in local search.

- 07 ☐ **A unique title & description per page**  
What shows in Google results. Include what you do and where — "Emergency Plumber in Leeds".

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- 08 ☐ **A Google Business Profile linked**  
The free listing that puts you on Maps and in the local "top 3". Link it to your site.

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- 09 ☐ **Location & service-area pages**  
Pages targeting the towns you serve so you rank for "[service] near me" in each one.

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- 10 ☐ **A sitemap submitted to Google**  
Tells search engines every page you have so nothing gets missed.

## PART 3 · TURN VISITORS INTO CUSTOMERS

# Convert the traffic you get

This is where most sites leak money. Every page should make the next step obvious.

- 11 ☐ **One clear call-to-action per page**  
"Call now", "Get a quote", "Book online" — tell people exactly what to do next.

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- 12 ☐ **Your phone number in the header**  
Tappable on mobile, visible on every page. Don't make people hunt for how to reach you.

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- 13 ☐ **A short, simple contact form**  
Name, email, message. Every extra field you add loses enquiries.

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- 14 ☐ **A WhatsApp or live chat option**  
Many people prefer to message. Make it a one-tap conversation.

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- 15 ☐ **Customer reviews & testimonials**  
Real 5-star reviews on the page tip undecided visitors into customers.

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- 16 ☐ **Trust signals**  
Accreditations, guarantees, years in business, "fully insured" — reasons to pick you.

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- 17 ☐ **Clear pricing or "get a quote"**  
Even "from £X" or a quote button removes friction and filters serious enquiries.

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- 18 ☐ **A lead magnet of your own**  
A free guide or checklist (like this one!) that captures emails you can follow up with.

## PART 4 · KEEP IT WORKING

# Stay safe, fast & growing

- 19 ☐ **Automatic backups**  
So one bad update or hack can't wipe your site off the map.

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- 20 ☐ **Regular software & security updates**  
Outdated sites get hacked. Keep everything patched.

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- 21 ☐ **Analytics installed**  
Know how many visit, where from, and what they click — so you improve what matters.

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- 22 ☐ **A blog or news section**  
Fresh, helpful content keeps Google interested and pulls in search traffic 24/7.

## The details that set you apart

- 23 ☐ **A custom 404 page**  
Guide lost visitors back instead of a dead end.
- 24 ☐ **Social share previews (OG images)**  
When your link is shared, it shows your logo and title — not a blank box.
- 25 ☐ **A privacy policy & cookie notice**  
Simple legal basics that keep you compliant and credible.
- 26 ☐ **Accessible to everyone**  
Good colour contrast and alt text — better for users and for SEO.
- 27 ☐ **Someone who keeps it all running**  
The difference between a site that quietly decays and one that keeps winning you work.

### How many did you tick?

If your site is missing more than a few of these, it's quietly costing you customers. We build fast, professional websites that check every box on this list — and we'll give you a free, honest review of your current site with no pressure.

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